الله
'ALLAH'
IS NOT
GOD
THE NAME OF THE CREATOR IS NOT UP FOR TRANSLATION!
IT'S TIME TO PROTECT THE MEANING OF TAWHEED!

# “Allah” Is Not <u>God</u>
# And It's Time Muslims Stopped Making That Substitution

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**You would never translate "Muhammad" into "The Praised One" and call him that instead.**

So why do we keep translating "Allah" into "God"?

This is not a trivial matter of linguistics. This is a matter of Tawhid, the very foundation upon which Islam stands or falls.

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In Surah Ta Ha, Ayah 14, Allah introduces Himself directly:

إِنَّنِيٓ أَنَا ٱللَّهُ

*"Indeed, it is I, Allah."*

Notice the triple emphasis: إِنَّ (indeed, truly, certainly), أَنَا (I, Myself), and then the proper noun ٱللَّهُ. This is not a casual introduction. This is the Creator of the heavens and the earth declaring His identity with unmistakable precision. He did not say "I am your God." He did not say "I am a deity." He said: **I am Allah.**

When the Creator Himself chooses a name, who are we to substitute it?

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## The Linguistic Argument

There is a fundamental rule in language that is widely understood among linguists and translators: **proper nouns are transliterated, never translated.**

When we encounter "Paris," we do not translate it to "The City" in another language. When we write "Muhammad," we do not convert it to "The Praised One" and use that instead.

Proper nouns carry identity. They are anchored to one specific entity and no other. Translation strips that anchor away.

**Allah** is a proper noun. It is the self-declared name of the Creator. It cannot be made plural. It has no feminine form. It has no masculine derivation. It cannot accommodate a prefix like "a" or "the", because the definite article is already fused within the word itself, originating from **al-Ilāh** (The One worthy of worship). The word, in its very structure, is an embodiment of absolute singularity.

To substitute "Allah" with "God" is to place the Creator of all existence into a linguistic category that He Himself has categorically rejected:

لَيْسَ كَمِثْلِهِ شَيْءٌ

*"There is nothing whatsoever like unto Him."* - Ash-Shura 42:11

Nothing. Not even a word.

## The Theological Danger

When Muslims casually use "God" instead of "Allah" in their writing, their speeches, their academic papers, and their everyday conversations, they unknowingly participate in a theological flattening. They place Allah, who is beyond all comparison, beyond all categories, beyond all human conceptual frameworks, onto a level playing field with every other deity ever imagined by human civilization.

This is not interfaith diplomacy. This is a dilution of Tawhid.

Allah has not left us guessing. He revealed His name. He reinforced it with emphasis. He supplemented it with 99 or more names and attributes "**Al-Asma ul-Husna**" each one a deliberate self-disclosure. And even these are only what He chose to reveal. Much of His nature, His attributes, and His names remain with Him, beyond our reach and comprehension.

Given this, how can we reduce all of that to a three-letter English word that humans have been applying to wooden idols and celestial myths for millennia?

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## A Call to Conscious Language

This is not about being difficult. It is not about refusing to communicate with non-Arabic speakers. It is about precision. It is about reverence. It is about honouring the One who honoured us with guidance.

The entire non-Muslim world already knows the word "Allah." It is not foreign. It is not inaccessible. Arab Christians use it. Linguists recognise it. Headlines print it. There is no barrier to its use — only a lazy habit of substitution that we have normalised for far too long.

If we are a people who believe that every word of the Quran is precise, that every letter carries weight, that the Arabic language was divinely chosen as the vessel of final revelation then we must extend that same conviction to the name of the One who sent it.

His name is **Allah**.

Not "God." Not "The Almighty" as a standalone replacement. Not a translation, not an approximation, not a cultural convenience.

**Allah.**

Say it. Write it. Honour it.

Because He told us Himself:

إِنَّنِيٓ أَنَا ٱللَّهُ

And that should be enough.

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*What are your thoughts? Do you believe the word "God" adequately represents Allah, or is it time we reclaimed linguistic precision in how we refer to our Creator?*

*I'd love to hear your perspective.*